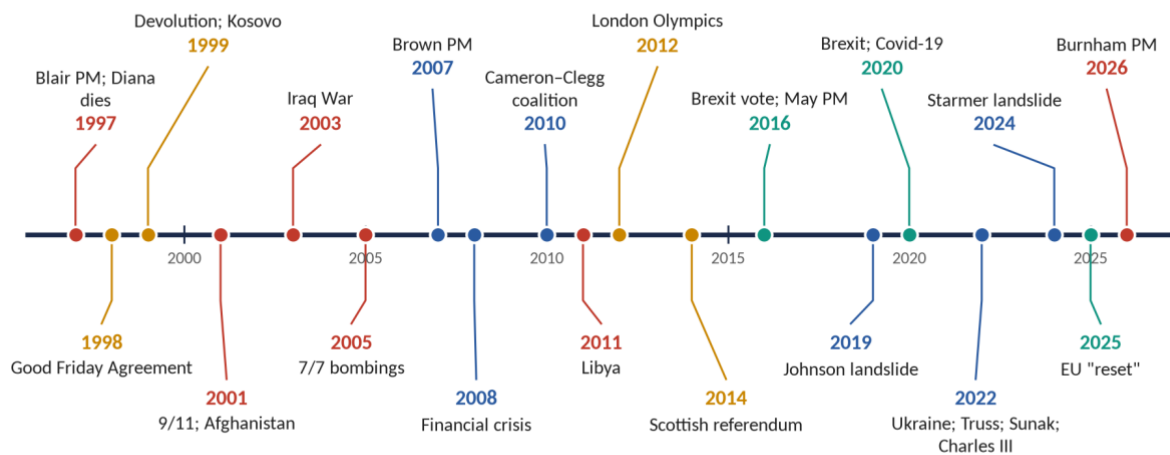


Blair to Burnham (1997–2026)

Contemporary Britain — New Labour, devolution and the Good Friday Agreement, the War on Terror and Iraq, the financial crisis, the Cameron coalition, Brexit, Covid, five Prime Ministers in eight years, Starmer's landslide and fall, and Andy Burnham's premiership (2026)

BRITAIN 1997–2026

red = war and terror · blue = governments and the economy · gold = the constitution · teal = Europe



Syllabus head XIV and beyond. 13 past items in 2015–2026 — the **War on Terror 3**, **New Labour 2**, the **financial crisis 2**, **Cameron 3**, **Brexit**, **Lady Diana 2** — and **8 MCQs**. Told from zero, then **eight chapters** from 1997 to 2026, with **120 one-liners** and a stand-alone **revision sheet**.

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HOW TO USE THIS · Updating the contents

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How to Use This Document

What this Topic covers

Topic 10 is **contemporary Britain**, from **Tony Blair**'s victory in **1997** through **Keir Starmer**'s government (2024–26) to **Andy Burnham**, Prime Minister from **July 2026**. The syllabus officially stops in 2012, but the examiner has asked about **Brexit**, the **financial crisis** and **David Cameron**, and the MCQs test events to 2010 and beyond — so this Knowledge Base carries the story to the present.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Why this topic matters

13 items in 2015–2026 and 8 MCQs — and growing fast (three full questions and three short notes in 2025–26 alone). The **War on Terror** (2021, 2023, 2026 sn), **New Labour** (2025, 2026), the **financial crisis** (2023, 2025), **Cameron** (2016; reforms sn 2024, 2025), **Brexit** (2017) and **Lady Diana** (sn 2018, 2026).

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS · Where this topic fits in the story

Topic 9 ended with the Conservatives' crushing defeat in **1997** after eighteen years in power. Topic 10 is the story of the four decades that followed — New Labour's thirteen years, the Conservatives' fourteen years (2010–24), and Labour's return.

Part Zero — The ABC Before the Story

0.1 The words you need

Word	What it means, simply
New Labour	Tony Blair's modernised Labour Party (from 1994–97): accepting markets while investing in public services.
Third Way	New Labour's idea of a path between old socialism and free-market Thatcherism.
Devolution	Handing powers from London to elected bodies in Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland.
Good Friday Agreement	The 1998 peace agreement for Northern Ireland.
War on Terror	The US-led campaign against terrorism after the attacks of 11 September 2001 ("9/11").
WMD	Weapons of mass destruction — chemical, biological or nuclear.
Financial crisis	The banking collapse of 2007–09 that caused a world recession.
Recession	A fall in national output (GDP) for at least two quarters in a row.
Austerity	Cutting public spending (and raising some taxes) to reduce government borrowing.
Quantitative easing (QE)	The Bank of England creating money to buy bonds, to push down interest rates and support the economy.
Coalition	A government of two or more parties — the Conservatives and Liberal Democrats, 2010–15.
Referendum	A national vote on a single question.
Brexit	Britain's exit from the European Union (voted 2016, left 2020).
Populism	Politics that sets "the people" against "the elite".

KEY IDEA · The one idea to hold on to

Blair's New Labour tried to combine a **market economy** with **social justice** and a **modernised constitution**, and made Britain America's closest ally in the **War on Terror**. The **financial crisis** of 2008 ended the long boom that had paid for its plans, brought a decade of **austerity**, and fed the anger that produced **Brexit** — the defining event of the century so far.

Part One — The Story

1.1 New Labour (1997–2007)

On **1 May 1997** **Tony Blair** won a landslide (**418** seats). New Labour gave the **Bank of England** independence, introduced a **minimum wage**, poured money into the **NHS** and schools, created a **Scottish Parliament** and **Welsh Assembly**, passed the **Human Rights Act**, and helped bring peace to **Northern Ireland** (the **Good Friday Agreement**, 1998). Months after Blair took office, **Diana, Princess of Wales**, died in a car crash in Paris; Blair called her "**the People's Princess**". Blair won again in **2001** and **2005**.

1.2 The War on Terror (2001–2021)

After terrorists attacked the USA on **11 September 2001**, Blair promised to stand "**shoulder to shoulder**" with America. British forces helped overthrow the **Taliban** in **Afghanistan** (2001) and joined the US invasion of **Iraq** (**2003**) — a war that split the country, because the **weapons of mass destruction** Blair had warned of were never found. In **July 2005** suicide bombers killed **52** people in London (7/7).

1.3 Brown and the crash (2007–2010)

Gordon Brown replaced Blair in **2007**. Within months the **global financial crisis** struck: **Northern Rock** collapsed, and in **October 2008** the government had to rescue the great banks. Britain fell into its deepest recession since the 1930s. In **2010** no party won a majority.

1.4 Cameron and the coalition (2010–2016)

David Cameron's Conservatives formed a **coalition** with **Nick Clegg's Liberal Democrats**. They cut spending (**austerity**), reformed welfare and schools, legalised **same-sex marriage**, and intervened in **Libya** (2011). Scotland voted to stay in the UK (**2014**). Cameron won a majority in **2015** and held a referendum on the EU; on **23 June 2016** Britain voted to **leave**.

1.5 Brexit and turmoil (2016–2024)

Theresa May could not get her Brexit deal through Parliament; **Boris Johnson** won a large majority in **December 2019** and took Britain out of the EU on **31 January 2020**. Then came the **Covid-19** pandemic (2020–22), scandals ("**partygate**"), **Liz Truss's** 49-day premiership (2022), and **Rishi Sunak**. In **September 2022** **Queen Elizabeth II** died after 70 years; **Charles III** became King.

1.6 Starmer and Burnham (2024–2026)

On **4 July 2024** **Keir Starmer's** Labour won **411** seats. His government promised growth and renewal, sought a "**reset**" with the EU (**2025**), and supported **Ukraine**, while facing a weak economy and the rise of **Reform UK**. After disastrous **May 2026** elections — Labour lost about 1,500 councillors, **Plaid Cymru** took power in Wales and **Reform UK** became the opposition there — Starmer's party turned on him. **Andy Burnham**, Mayor of Greater Manchester, returned to Parliament at the **Makerfield by-election (18 June 2026)**; Starmer announced his resignation (**22 June**), and Burnham, elected Labour leader unopposed, became **Prime Minister on 20 July 2026**.

VERDICT · The story in one sentence

From 1997 to 2026 Britain moved from New Labour's confident renewal, through the War on Terror and the financial crash, to austerity, Brexit and political turmoil — ending with Labour back in power in an anxious, divided country, where even a landslide government lasted only two years under its first leader.

Part Two — The Cast and the Time-line

2.1 The cast

Person	Office	Who they were — in one line
Tony Blair	PM 1997–2007	Created New Labour; three election wins; Iraq.
Gordon Brown	Chancellor 1997–2007; PM 2007–10	The long boom; the financial-crisis rescue.
Robin Cook	Foreign Sec. 1997–2001	"Ethical dimension"; resigned over Iraq (2003).
Diana, Princess of Wales	1961–97	"The People's Princess"; died 31 August 1997.
George W. Bush	US President 2001–09	Led the War on Terror.
David Cameron	PM 2010–16	Coalition; austerity; the EU referendum.
Nick Clegg	Deputy PM 2010–15	Liberal Democrat leader in the coalition.
George Osborne	Chancellor 2010–16	Austerity.
Theresa May	PM 2016–19	Brexit negotiations.
Boris Johnson	PM 2019–22	"Get Brexit done"; Covid; partygate.
Liz Truss	PM Sept–Oct 2022	The shortest-serving PM.
Rishi Sunak	PM 2022–24	First British Asian PM.
Keir Starmer	PM 2024–26	Labour's landslide; resigned after the May 2026 elections.
Andy Burnham	PM from July 2026	Former Mayor of Greater Manchester; returned to Parliament for Makerfield (June 2026).
Charles III	King from 2022	Succeeded Elizabeth II.

2.2 The time-line

BRITAIN 1997–2026

red = war and terror · blue = governments and the economy · gold = the constitution · teal = Europe

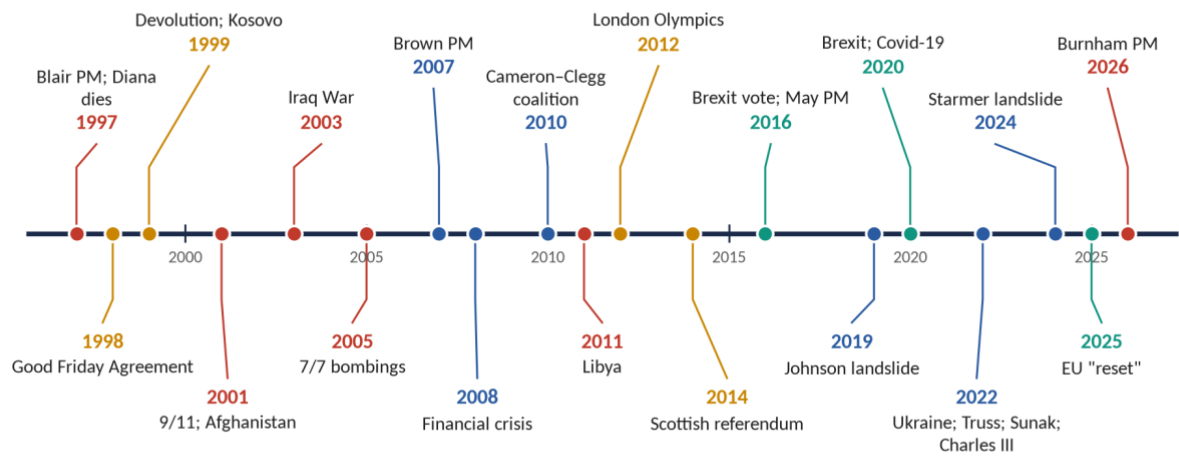


Figure 1 · Britain 1997–2026.

Part Three — The Chapters

Chapter 1 · New Labour (1997–2010)

OLD LABOUR, THATCHERISM AND NEW LABOUR

Continuity and change

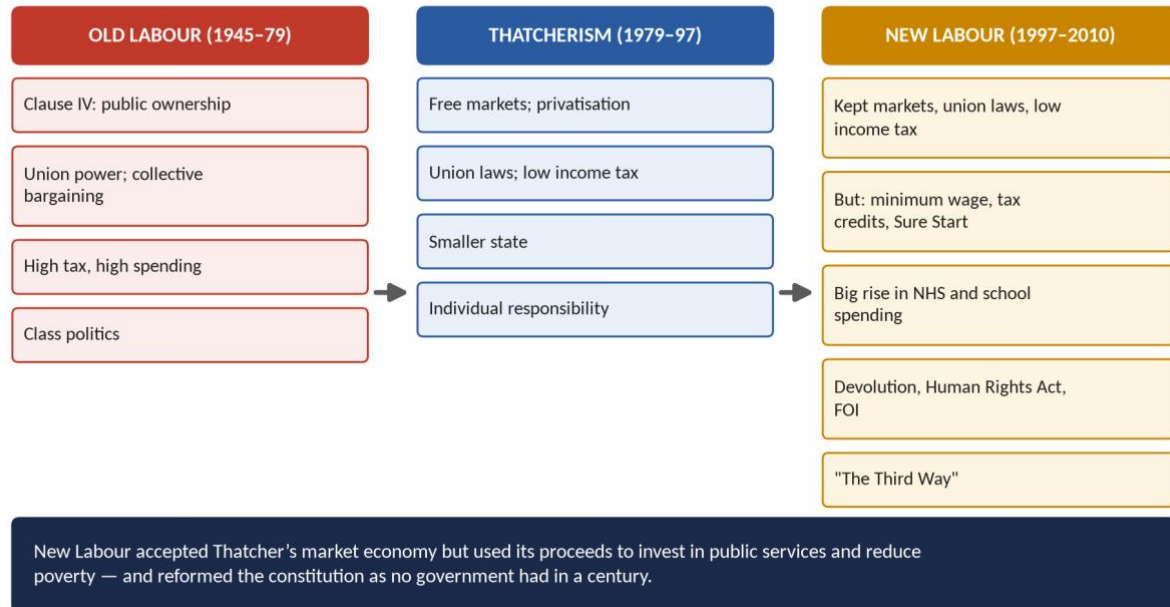


Figure 2 · Old Labour, Thatcherism and New Labour.

1.1 The making of New Labour

- **Four defeats** (1979, 1983, 1987, 1992) convinced Labour's modernisers that the party had to change.
- **Neil Kinnock** (1983–92) expelled the Militant Tendency and dropped unilateral disarmament; **John Smith** (1992–94) introduced "one member, one vote".
- **Tony Blair** (leader from **July 1994**) rewrote **Clause IV (1995)**: public ownership replaced by "a dynamic economy ... the enterprise of the market and the rigour of competition ... with a just society".
- **The "Third Way"** (sociologist **Anthony Giddens**, 1998): between old state socialism and free-market neo-liberalism.
- **Slogans**: "Education, education, education"; "tough on crime, tough on the causes of crime"; "New Labour, New Britain".

1.2 Elections

LABOUR SEATS AT EACH GENERAL ELECTION, 1997–2024

Of 650 or so seats; about 326 are needed for a majority

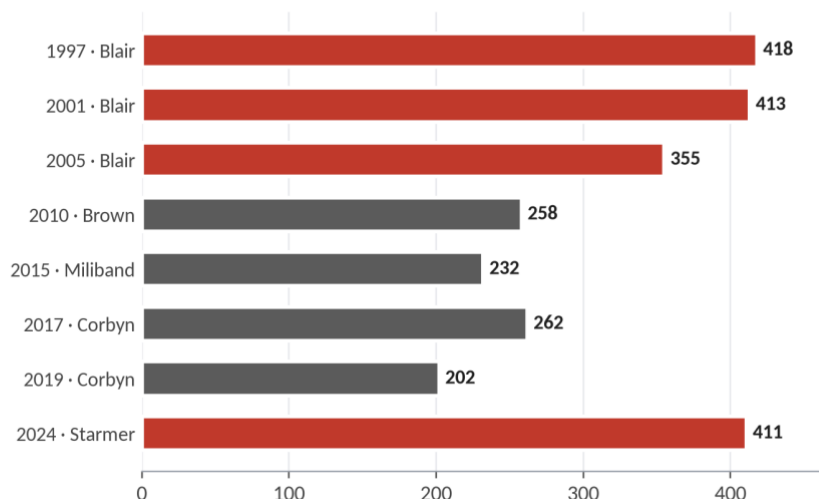


Figure 3 · Labour seats, 1997–2024.

Election	Labour seats	Majority
1 May 1997	418	179
7 June 2001	413	167
5 May 2005	355	66

1.3 The economy

- **Bank of England independence (May 1997)**: the Bank set interest rates to meet an inflation target.
- **Gordon Brown's "prudence"**: two years within Conservative spending limits; "no return to boom and bust".
- **Low income tax** kept (basic rate cut to 22p, then **20p** in 2008); a **windfall tax** on privatised utilities paid for the **New Deal** for young unemployed.
- **The long boom**: steady growth until 2007; employment rose.
- **But**: light-touch regulation of the City (the Financial Services Authority, 1997); rising household and public debt; **PFI** (private finance for hospitals and schools) stored up costs.

1.4 Social policy

- **The National Minimum Wage (April 1999, £3.60 an hour)** — opposed by the Conservatives, now accepted by all.
- **Tax credits** (Working Families Tax Credit, 1999; Child Tax Credit, 2003); the **Winter Fuel Payment**.

- **Child poverty:** a pledge (1999) to halve it by 2010 and end it by 2020 — it fell by about 600,000 children by 2010, short of the target.
- **Sure Start (1998):** children's centres for families in poor areas.
- **Health:** NHS spending roughly **doubled** in real terms (1997–2010); waiting times fell sharply; but targets and PFI were criticised.
- **Education: literacy and numeracy hours; academies (2000);** more teachers; **tuition fees (1998, £1,000; "top-up" fees to £3,000 in 2004);** 50 per cent university target.
- **Crime:** more police; ASBOs (1998).
- **Social liberalism: civil partnerships (2004);** equalised age of consent (2000); the **fox-hunting ban (2004);** the **Equality Act (2010).**

1.5 Constitutional reform — the biggest in a century

1. **Devolution:** referendums (September **1997**); the **Scottish Parliament** and **Welsh Assembly** opened in **1999**; the **Northern Ireland Assembly** (1998); a **Mayor of London (2000).**
2. **The Good Friday Agreement (10 April 1998):** power-sharing in Northern Ireland between unionists and nationalists; the Irish Republic dropped its territorial claim; a united Ireland only by majority consent; prisoners released; confirmed by referendums in both parts of Ireland (May 1998). Blair, Bertie Ahern, US Senator **George Mitchell**, David Trimble and John Hume (Nobel Prize 1998).
3. **The Human Rights Act (1998, in force 2000):** the European Convention on Human Rights made part of UK law.
4. **The House of Lords Act (1999):** most hereditary peers removed (**92** kept).
5. **The Freedom of Information Act (2000, in force 2005).**
6. **The Constitutional Reform Act (2005):** a **Supreme Court** (opened **2009**) replaced the Law Lords.
7. **Bank of England independence (1997).**

1.6 Foreign policy

- "An ethical dimension" (**Robin Cook, 1997**).
- **Kosovo (1999):** NATO bombing to stop Serbian ethnic cleansing; Blair's **Chicago speech (April 1999)** set out the "**doctrine of the international community**" — intervention to stop humanitarian disasters.
- **Sierra Leone (2000):** a British force saved the capital from rebels (Operation Palliser).
- **The Department for International Development (1997);** aid doubled; debt relief; the **Gleneagles G8 (2005)** on Africa and climate.
- **Europe:** signed the **Social Chapter (1997); St Malo (1998)** on European defence; stayed out of the **euro.**
- **The War on Terror and Iraq — Chapter 2.**

1.7 Gordon Brown (2007–2010)

- Became PM in **June 2007** unopposed; dithered over an early election (autumn 2007).
- **The financial crisis** (Chapter 3); the **Climate Change Act (2008)** — the world's first legally binding carbon target.
- **The MPs' expenses scandal (May 2009)**.
- **The 2010 election: a hung parliament** (Conservatives 306, Labour 258, Liberal Democrats 57).

1.8 New Labour: Old Labour, Thatcherism — or something new?

Area	Old Labour (1945–79)	Thatcherism (1979–97)	New Labour (1997–2010)
Ownership	Nationalisation (Clause IV)	Privatisation	Kept privatisation; PFI
Unions	Partners in government	Curbed by law	Laws kept; unions at arm's length
Tax	High, redistributive	Low income tax	Low income tax; "redistribution by stealth"
Spending	High	Restrained	Big rises for NHS and schools
Poverty	Welfare state	Less priority	Minimum wage, tax credits, Sure Start
Constitution	Little change	Centralisation	Devolution, HRA, FOI, Lords
Voters	Working class	Aspiring middle class	"Big tent": both

- **"Thatcherism by other means"?** — Stuart Hall called New Labour **"the great moving nowhere show"** (1998); Thatcher reportedly called New Labour her **"greatest achievement"** (2002).
- **A distinct project?** — its investment in public services, attack on poverty and constitutional revolution went far beyond anything Thatcher would have done.
- **Verdict:** a distinct project built on Thatcherite foundations.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Where Chapter 1 has been asked

2025 Q6 (New Labour v previous Labour governments; Thatcherism or a distinct project?) · **2026 Q7** (1997–2012: renewal or contradictions?). MCQs **2025:** Blair led the **Labour** Party; **2026:** the Good Friday Agreement addressed **Northern Ireland**.

Chapter 2 · The War on Terror

BRITAIN AND THE "WAR ON TERROR"

Afghanistan, Iraq and the home front

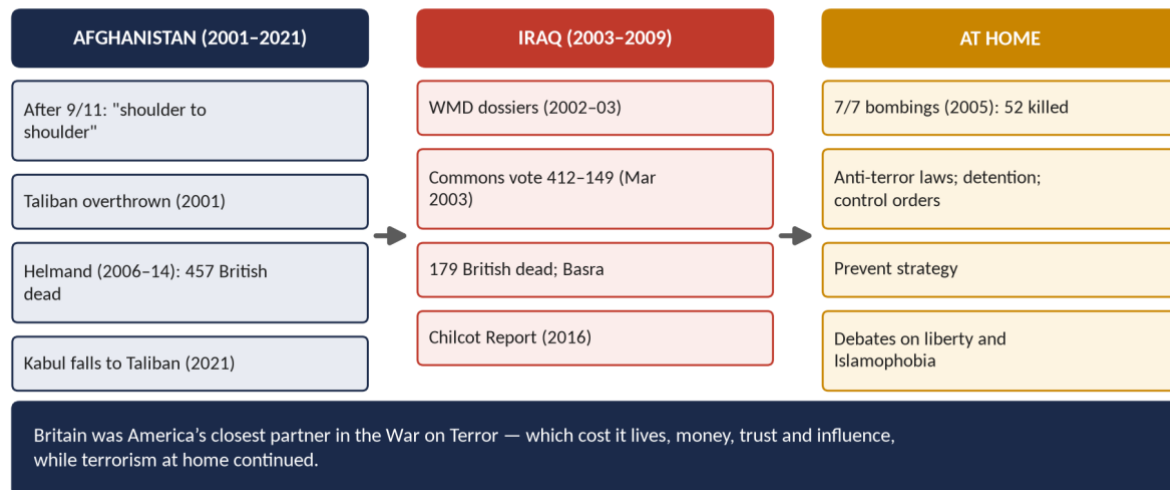


Figure 4 · Britain and the War on Terror.

2.1 9/11 and the response

- **11 September 2001:** al-Qaeda terrorists hijacked four airliners and attacked the World Trade Center and the Pentagon; about **3,000** killed, including **67** Britons.
- **President George W. Bush** declared a "**War on Terror**". On **15 September** he said: "We will find those who did it, we will smoke them out of their holes, we will get them running and we will bring them to justice."
- **Blair:** Britain would stand "**shoulder to shoulder**" with America; he became the chief international advocate of the campaign.

2.2 Afghanistan (2001-2021)

- **October 2001:** US and British forces attacked the **Taliban** government, which sheltered **Osama bin Laden**; Kabul fell in November.
- **ISAF (NATO)** from 2001; British forces took over **Helmand** province (**2006**) — heavy fighting (Camp Bastion; Sangin).
- **British combat operations ended in October 2014;** **457** British servicemen died.
- **August 2021:** after the US withdrawal, the Taliban retook Kabul; Britain evacuated about 15,000 people (Operation Pitting).
- **Bin Laden** was killed by US forces in Pakistan (**May 2011**).

2.3 Iraq (2003–2009)

(i) The case for war

- Saddam Hussein was said to possess **weapons of mass destruction** and to defy UN resolutions; the "**axis of evil**" (Bush, 2002).
- **The September Dossier (2002)** claimed Iraq could deploy WMD "within **45 minutes**"; the "**dodgy dossier**" (February 2003) was partly copied from a student thesis.
- **UN Resolution 1441 (November 2002)** gave Iraq a "final opportunity"; Blair failed to get a second resolution.

(ii) Opposition

- About **1 million** marched in London (**15 February 2003**).
- **The Commons vote (18 March 2003)**: 412 to 149 for war — **139 Labour MPs** rebelled; **Robin Cook** resigned.
- France, Germany and Russia opposed the war.

(iii) The war

- **20 March 2003**: the invasion; about **46,000** British troops; Basra taken; Saddam fell in April.
- **No WMD were found**.
- Insurgency and sectarian civil war; British forces in **Basra** until **2009**; **179** British deaths; Iraqi deaths estimated in the **hundreds of thousands**.
- **Dr David Kelly**, a weapons expert and BBC source, died (July 2003); the **Hutton Report** (2004) cleared the government; the **Butler Review** (2004) criticised the intelligence.

(iv) The Chilcot Report (6 July 2016)

Found that Britain went to war **before peaceful options were exhausted**, that the WMD threat was presented with unjustified certainty, that planning for the aftermath was "wholly inadequate", and published Blair's note to Bush (**July 2002**): "**I will be with you, whatever.**"

2.4 The home front

- **Terrorism laws**: the Terrorism Act (**2000**); the **Anti-terrorism, Crime and Security Act (2001)** allowed indefinite detention of foreign suspects without trial (**Belmarsh**) — ruled incompatible with human rights by the Law Lords (**2004**); **control orders (2005)**; Blair's first Commons defeat: **90-day** detention rejected (**November 2005**) — 28 days allowed.
- **7/7 (7 July 2005)**: four British-born suicide bombers attacked three Underground trains and a bus; **52** killed.
- **Prevent** (from **2006–07**): a strategy to stop radicalisation — criticised for targeting Muslims.

- **Later attacks:** Lee Rigby (2013); Westminster, Manchester Arena and London Bridge (2017).
- **Controversies:** complicity in **rendition** and torture (the Libya case, the 2018 Intelligence and Security Committee reports); Guantánamo.

2.5 The effect on British–American relations

- **Closer:** Blair and Bush had the closest partnership since Churchill and Roosevelt; intelligence and military integration deepened.
- **British influence:** Blair persuaded Bush to go to the **UN** (1441) and to launch the **Middle East "road map"** (2003); he saw himself as the "bridge" between America and Europe.
- **Costs:** Blair was mocked as "**Bush's poodle**"; the bridge to Europe broke (France and Germany); British public trust in the relationship fell.
- **Afterwards:** Brown and Cameron were more cautious; **Obama** spoke of an "essential relationship"; the Commons refused Syria strikes (2013) — the "Iraq syndrome".

2.6 A balanced critique

Achievements	Failures and costs
Al-Qaeda's Afghan base destroyed; bin Laden killed (2011)	Iraq invaded on false WMD claims; legality disputed
Many plots foiled; no repeat of 9/11 on its scale	Hundreds of thousands of Iraqi and Afghan deaths
International cooperation on intelligence and finance	Chaos in Iraq helped create ISIS (2014)
Some democratic progress in Afghanistan (2001–21)	The Taliban returned (2021)
	Torture, rendition, detention without trial damaged the West's values
	Terrorism in Britain increased (7/7, 2017)

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Where Chapter 2 has been asked

2021 Q8 (Blair's War on Terror; US–British relations) · **2023 Q7** (a balanced critique, with Bush's words) · **2026 Q8(a)** (short note). MCQs **2024:** Iraq 2003 → **Tony Blair**; **2026:** 7/7 was in **2005**.

Chapter 3 · The Global Financial Crisis and Austerity

THE GLOBAL FINANCIAL CRISIS AND BRITAIN

From Northern Rock to austerity

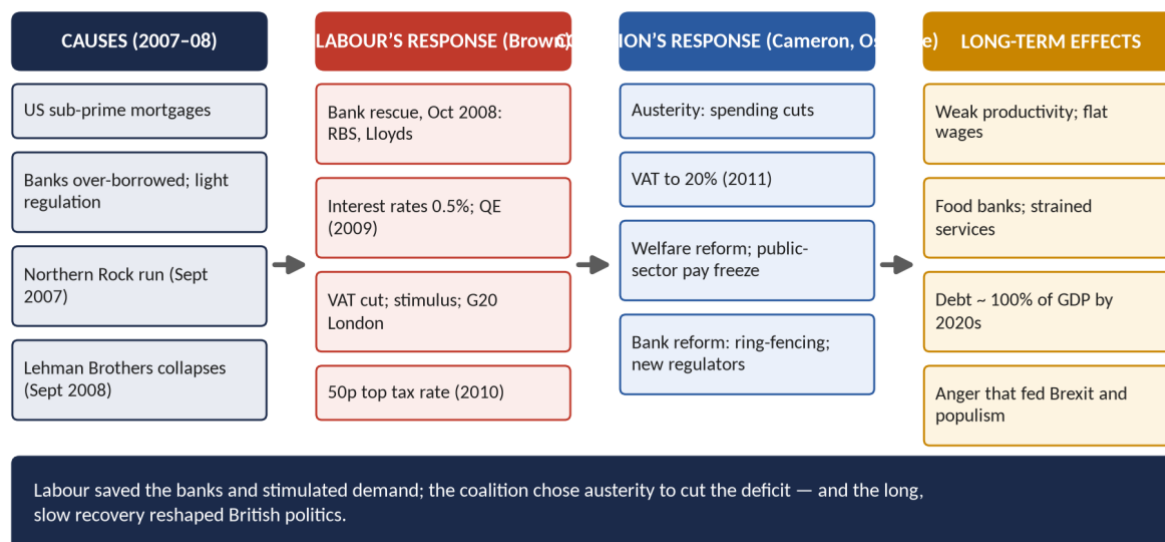


Figure 5 · The financial crisis and Britain.

3.1 How the crisis began

- **The US housing bubble:** banks lent to "**sub-prime**" borrowers who could not repay; the loans were packaged into complex securities and sold worldwide.
- **British banks** had grown enormously — their assets were over **four times** the size of the economy — and borrowed heavily on the money markets.
- **Light-touch regulation:** the Financial Services Authority failed to see the risks.

3.2 The crisis in Britain

Date	Event
Sept 2007	Northern Rock asked the Bank of England for help; savers queued outside — the first bank run in Britain for about 150 years. Nationalised February 2008 .
Sept 2008	Lehman Brothers collapsed in New York (15 September); HBOS was rescued by Lloyds ; Bradford & Bingley nationalised.
8 Oct 2008	The bank rescue: about £500 billion of guarantees, loans and capital; the state took large stakes in RBS (eventually about 84 per cent) and Lloyds (about 43 per cent).
Oct–Dec 2008	Interest rates cut; VAT cut from 17.5 to 15 per cent (December 2008 – 2010); car scrappage scheme.
Mar 2009	Bank Rate cut to 0.5 per cent ; quantitative easing began (£75 billion, rising to £375 billion by 2012).
Apr 2009	The G20 London summit: about \$1 trillion for the IMF and world economy — Brown's leadership was widely praised.

3.3 The recession

- **GDP fell by about 6 per cent** (2008–09) — the deepest recession since the Second World War.
- **Unemployment** rose to about **2.5 million** (2009) and peaked at about **2.7 million** (2011).
- **Government borrowing** soared to about **10 per cent** of GDP (2009–10); debt rose from about 40 to over 80 per cent of GDP.
- House prices fell; lending dried up (the "**credit crunch**").

3.4 Two responses compared

	Labour (Brown and Darling, 2008–10)	Conservative-led coalition (Cameron and Osborne, 2010–16)
Philosophy	Keynesian : support demand; borrow in a slump	Fiscal consolidation : cut the deficit to restore confidence
Banks	Rescue and part-nationalisation	Reform: ring-fencing (Vickers, 2011; Banking Reform Act 2013); FSA replaced by the PRA and FCA (2013); a bank levy
Tax	VAT cut; 50p top rate (2010)	VAT to 20 per cent (2011); 50p cut to 45p (2013); tax-free allowance raised
Spending	Maintained or increased	Deep cuts to departments, local government and welfare
Welfare	Protected	Benefit cap; freezes; Universal Credit
Aim	Protect jobs and output	Eliminate the deficit (target missed several times)

3.5 The impact on politics and society

- **Politics**: Labour's defeat (**2010**); the first coalition since 1945; the **MPs' expenses scandal** (2009) deepened distrust; the **Occupy** protests (2011); student protests over **tuition fees** (2010); the **2011 riots**; the rise of **UKIP**; the **Scottish independence** campaign; the **Brexit** vote (2016) — research found austerity increased support for Leave.
- **Society**: wage stagnation — real wages did not return to their 2008 level for over a decade; **food banks** (the Trussell Trust's use rose from about 26,000 people in 2008–09 to over 1 million by 2014–15); cuts to local services, libraries and youth centres; young people found housing unaffordable; **inequality** and regional divides grew.

3.6 Long-term effects

1. **Weak productivity and growth**: the "**productivity puzzle**" — growth well below pre-2008 trends.

2. **Low interest rates and QE** (to 2021) inflated asset prices — helping the wealthy.
3. **Public services strained** by a decade of cuts (the NHS, local government, prisons, courts).
4. **Debt** stayed high — near **100 per cent** of GDP after Covid.
5. **A safer banking system**: capital rules; ring-fencing; the Bank of England's Financial Policy Committee.
6. **Political upheaval**: the anger of the "left behind" fed Brexit and populism.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Where Chapter 3 has been asked

2023 Q8 (how the crisis caused recession and how Britain responded) · **2025 Q7** (impact on politics and society; Labour and Conservative responses; long-term effects). MCQ **2025**: the downturn of 2008 is the **Financial Crisis**.

Chapter 4 · David Cameron (2010–2016)

REFORMS UNDER DAVID CAMERON (2010–2016)

The coalition with the Liberal Democrats (2010–15) and the Conservative majority (2015–16)

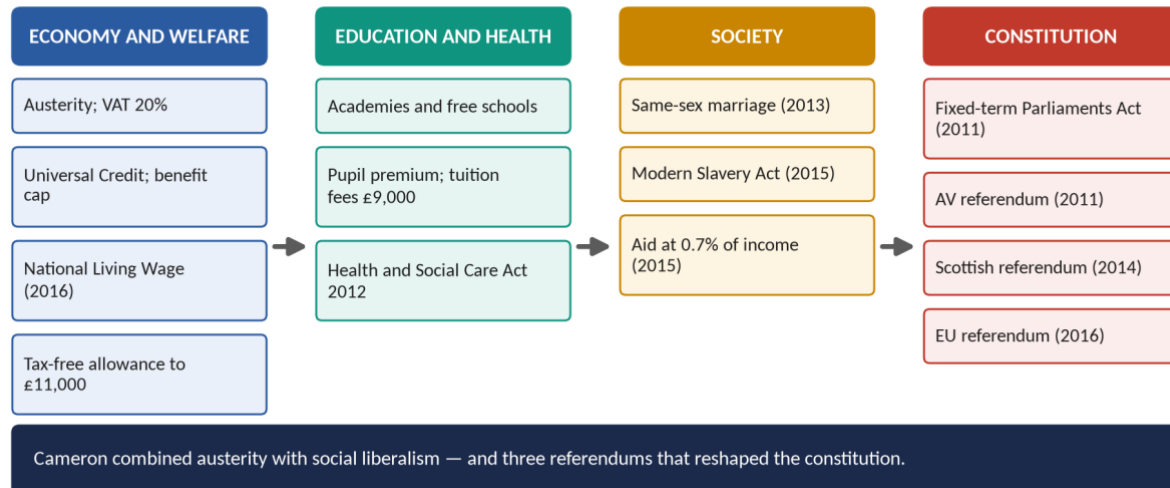


Figure 6 · *Reforms under Cameron.*

4.1 The coalition

- **The 2010 election** produced a **hung parliament**; after five days of talks the **Conservatives** and **Liberal Democrats** formed a **coalition (11 May 2010)**: **David Cameron** PM, **Nick Clegg** Deputy PM.
- **The Coalition Agreement**: deficit reduction; a referendum on the Alternative Vote; fixed-term parliaments; Liberal Democrat priorities such as raising the tax-free allowance and the pupil premium.
- **2015**: the Conservatives won a majority of **12**; the Liberal Democrats collapsed (8 seats).

4.2 Reforms under Cameron

(i) Economy and welfare

- **Austerity** (Osborne): the emergency budget (June 2010); VAT to **20 per cent** (January 2011); departmental cuts of about a fifth; public-sector pay freezes.
- **Welfare Reform Act (2012)**: **Universal Credit** (merging six benefits); the **benefit cap** (2013); the "**bedroom tax**" (2013).
- **The tax-free personal allowance** raised from £6,475 to **£11,000** (2016) — a Liberal Democrat policy.
- **Pensions**: the **triple lock** (2010–11); automatic enrolment in workplace pensions (**2012**); pension freedoms (2015).
- **The National Living Wage** (**April 2016**, £7.20 for over-25s).

(ii) Education

- **The Academies Act (2010)**: most secondary schools became **academies**; **free schools** set up by parents and charities.
- **Michael Gove's reforms**: a tougher national curriculum; GCSEs graded 9–1; A-level reform.
- **The pupil premium (2011)**: extra money for poorer pupils.
- **University tuition fees up to £9,000 (2012)** — breaking the Liberal Democrats' pledge.

(iii) Health

The Health and Social Care Act (2012, Andrew Lansley): GP-led clinical commissioning groups and more competition — controversial and later largely reversed.

(iv) Society

- **Same-sex marriage (Marriage (Same Sex Couples) Act 2013)**; first weddings March 2014) — Cameron's proudest achievement.
- **The Modern Slavery Act (2015)**.
- **Overseas aid at 0.7 per cent** of national income written into law (2015).
- **The "Big Society"**: volunteering and community action.
- **The Leveson Inquiry (2011–12)** into press standards after phone hacking.
- **Police and crime commissioners (2012)**.

(v) The constitution

- **The Fixed-term Parliaments Act (2011)**.
- **The Alternative Vote referendum (May 2011)**: rejected, 68 per cent No.
- **The Scottish independence referendum (18 September 2014)**: **55.3 per cent No**; more powers followed (Scotland Act 2016).
- **English Votes for English Laws (2015)**; recall of MPs (2015).
- **The EU referendum (23 June 2016)** — which ended his premiership.

4.3 Cameron's foreign policy

(i) General features

- **"Liberal conservatism"**: support for freedom and democracy, but cautious, practical, "not naive" after Iraq.
- **Commercial diplomacy**: trade missions; the **"golden era"** with **China** (Xi Jinping's state visit, October 2015).
- **Aid**: 0.7 per cent of national income.
- **Defence**: cuts in the 2010 review; a NATO 2 per cent pledge (2015).
- **Russia**: sanctions after the annexation of **Crimea** (2014).
- **Europe**: the Bloomberg speech (2013), renegotiation (2016), referendum.

(ii) The Middle East

1. **The Arab Spring (2011)**: support for the uprisings.
2. **Libya (March–October 2011)**: with France's Sarkozy, Cameron pushed for **UN Resolution 1973**; NATO air strikes protected civilians and helped rebels overthrow **Gaddafi** (killed October 2011). Libya then fell into chaos; the Commons Foreign Affairs Committee (**2016**) criticised the intervention's planning.
3. **Syria**: Cameron demanded that **Assad** go; after a chemical attack (Ghouta, August 2013) he sought support for strikes, but the **Commons voted against (29 August 2013, 285 to 272)** — the first time since 1782 a PM had lost a vote on war; Britain resettled Syrian refugees (**20,000** pledged, 2015).
4. **ISIS**: air strikes in **Iraq** (from **September 2014**) and **Syria** (after a Commons vote, **December 2015**).
5. **Iran**: the nuclear deal (**JCPOA, July 2015**); the British embassy in Tehran reopened (August 2015).
6. **The Gulf**: close ties with **Saudi Arabia** (arms sales, criticised over the war in Yemen from 2015); a permanent naval base in **Bahrain** (agreed 2014).
7. **Israel and Palestine**: support for a two-state solution; he called Gaza a "prison camp" (2010); a non-binding Commons vote (2014) to recognise Palestine.
8. **Afghanistan**: combat operations ended (**2014**).

BRITAIN'S WARS AND INTERVENTIONS, 1997–2026

From Kosovo and Afghanistan to Iraq, Libya and Syria

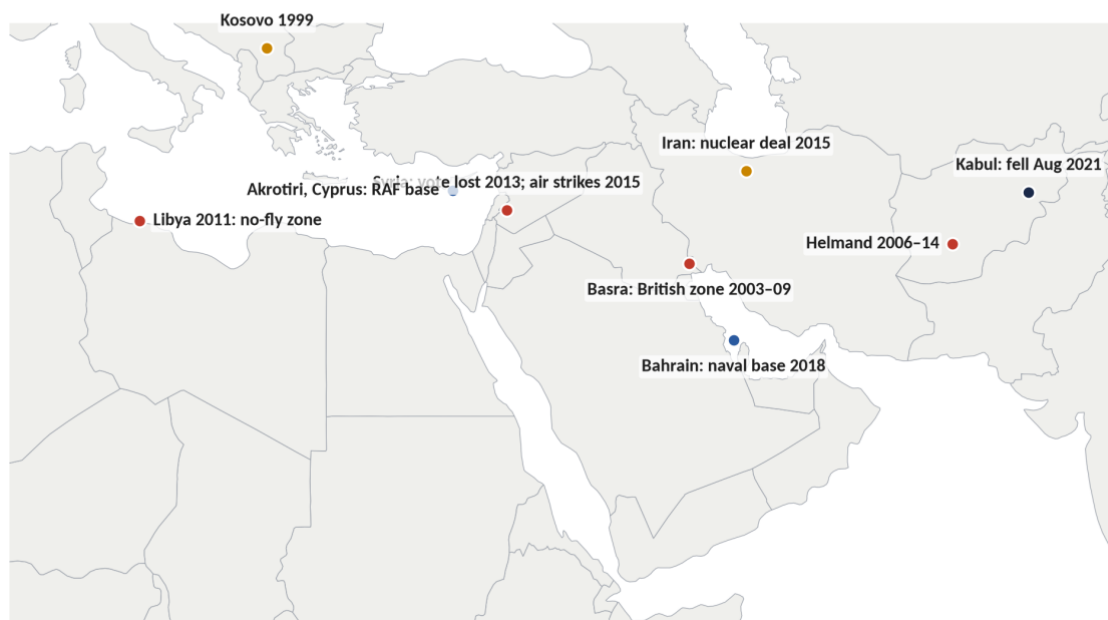


Figure 7 · Britain's interventions, 1997–2026.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Where Chapter 4 has been asked

2016 Q7 (Cameron's foreign policy, with reference to the Middle East) · **2024 Q7(b)** and **2025 Q8(c)** (short notes: reforms under Cameron). MCQs **2025**: Cameron formed a **coalition** government in 2010; **2026**: with the **Liberal Democrats**, led by **Cameron**.

Chapter 5 · Brexit (2016–2026)

BREXIT: ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES

The arguments of 2016 and the evidence since 2020

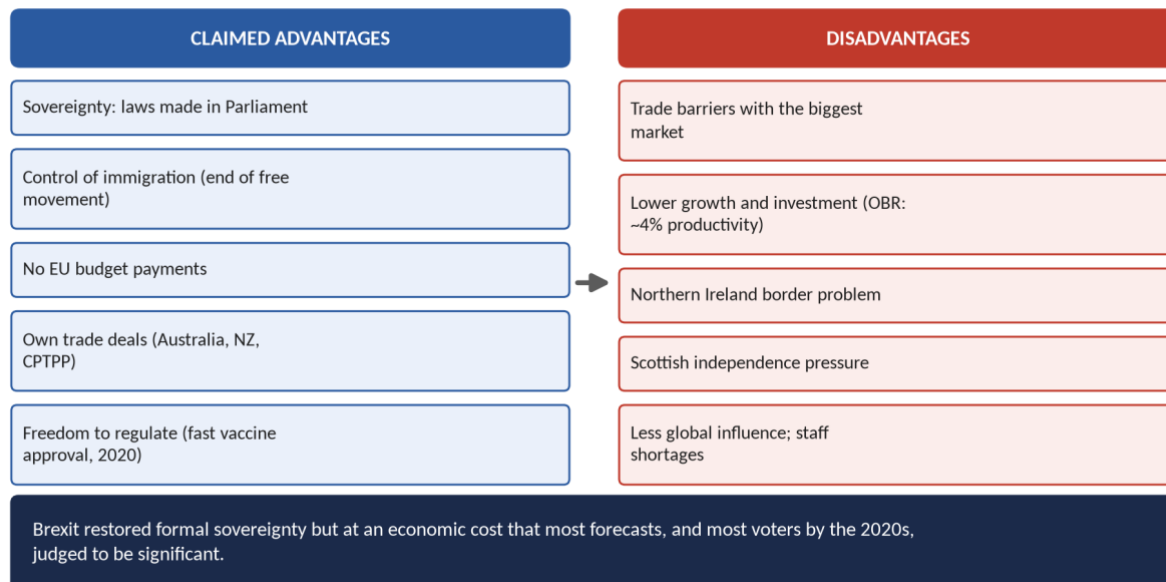


Figure 8 · Brexit: advantages and disadvantages.

5.1 The road to the referendum

Euroscepticism in the Conservative Party (Maastricht); **UKIP's** rise (first in the 2014 European elections); immigration after **2004**; Cameron's **Bloomberg speech (January 2013)** promising a referendum; his renegotiation (February 2016).

5.2 The referendum (23 June 2016)

- **Leave 51.9 per cent** (17.4 million), **Remain 48.1 per cent**; turnout **72 per cent**.
- England and Wales voted Leave; **Scotland** (62 per cent Remain) and **Northern Ireland** (56 per cent) voted Remain.
- **Leave arguments: "Take Back Control"** of laws, money and borders; £350 million a week for the NHS (a disputed figure).
- **Remain arguments:** the economy, jobs, security, influence.
- Cameron resigned.

5.3 Leaving (2016–2020)

- **Theresa May** (July 2016): Article 50 triggered (**29 March 2017**); lost her majority in the **June 2017** election; her deal was defeated three times (2019, the first by **230 votes** — the largest government defeat ever); she resigned.

- **Boris Johnson** (July 2019): a new deal (the **Northern Ireland Protocol**); "**Get Brexit Done**" — a majority of **80 (December 2019)**.
- **Britain left** on **31 January 2020**; the **Trade and Cooperation Agreement (24 December 2020)** — tariff-free trade in goods, but new customs and regulatory barriers.
- **The Windsor Framework (February 2023)** eased the Northern Ireland Protocol.

5.4 Advantages and disadvantages — the arguments and the evidence

Area	Advantages (claimed and actual)	Disadvantages (claimed and actual)
Sovereignty	Laws made by Parliament; the EU Court no longer supreme	Must still follow EU rules to trade; less say in making them
Money	No annual net EU contribution (about £9–10 billion)	Lost EU funds for regions, farming, science (some replaced)
Trade	Own trade deals: Australia, New Zealand, CPTPP (joined 2024–25), India (2025)	New barriers with the EU (about 40% of trade); OBR: trade about 15% lower in the long run
The economy	Freedom to regulate (the fast approval of the Covid vaccine , December 2020)	OBR: productivity about 4 per cent lower in the long run; weaker investment
Immigration	End of free movement ; a points-based system	Labour shortages (lorry drivers, care); net migration actually rose to record levels (about 900,000 in 2022–23)
Fishing and farming	Control of waters	Fishermen disappointed; export barriers
The Union	—	Northern Ireland border problem; stronger demand for Scottish independence
Influence	"Global Britain"; free to act (e.g. early support for Ukraine)	Less influence in Europe; weaker in Washington and Beijing
Culture and science	The Turing scheme	Left Erasmus; Horizon science rejoined only in 2024

5.5 Public opinion and the "reset"

- By the early 2020s most polls found a majority thought Brexit was the **wrong decision**.
- **Starmer** ruled out rejoining the single market or customs union but sought a "**reset**": the **UK–EU summit (May 2025)** agreed a security and defence partnership and talks on food and agricultural standards, youth mobility and energy.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Where Chapter 5 has been asked

2017 Q8 (advantages and disadvantages of Brexit).

Chapter 6 · Lady Diana (1961–1997)

- **Born** Diana Spencer on **1 July 1961** at Sandringham, daughter of Earl Spencer.
- **Married Prince Charles** on **29 July 1981** at St Paul's Cathedral — watched by about **750 million** people worldwide.
- **Sons: Prince William** (1982) and **Prince Harry** (1984).
- **Charity and humanitarian work:**
 - **HIV/AIDS** — in **1987** she shook hands with an AIDS patient without gloves, challenging stigma.
 - **Leprosy**, homelessness, children's hospitals, cancer.
 - **Landmines** — she walked through a minefield in **Angola (January 1997)** and visited Bosnia; the **Ottawa Treaty** banning landmines was signed in **December 1997**.
- **The marriage broke down:** separation (**1992**); her **BBC Panorama** interview (**November 1995**): "**There were three of us in this marriage**"; divorce (**August 1996**).
- **Death:** killed in a car crash in the **Pont de l'Alma tunnel, Paris**, on **31 August 1997**, with Dodi Fayed, pursued by photographers.
- "**The People's Princess**": Tony Blair's tribute; a huge outpouring of public grief; flowers outside Kensington Palace.
- **The monarchy under pressure:** the Queen was criticised for staying at Balmoral; she returned and spoke on television; the royal family became more open and informal.
- **Funeral: 6 September 1997**; Elton John's "Candle in the Wind 1997".
- **Inquiries: Operation Paget** (2006) and the **inquest (2008)**: unlawful killing through the gross negligence of the driver and the pursuing paparazzi. The **Dyson report (2021)** found the BBC had used deceit to obtain the Panorama interview.
- **Legacy:** a modernised, more emotional public culture; her sons' charitable work; her place as a global icon.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Where Chapter 6 has been asked

2018 Q8(c) (short note: Lady Diana) · **2026 Q8(b)** (short note: Lady Diana Spencer).

Chapter 7 · Britain since 2016

7.1 May, Johnson, Truss, Sunak

- **Theresa May** (2016–19): Brexit; the **Grenfell Tower** fire (June 2017, 72 dead); the Salisbury poisoning (2018).
- **Boris Johnson** (2019–22): Brexit done; **Covid-19** — lockdowns (from March 2020), the successful vaccine programme (from December 2020), about 230,000 deaths; "partygate"; support for **Ukraine** after Russia's invasion (**February 2022**); resigned after ministerial resignations (July 2022).
- **Liz Truss** (**September–October 2022**): the "mini-budget" of unfunded tax cuts crashed the pound and gilt markets; she resigned after **49 days** — the shortest premiership in British history.
- **Rishi Sunak** (**October 2022 – July 2024**): the first British Asian and Hindu Prime Minister; stabilised the finances; the Windsor Framework; the Rwanda asylum scheme.
- **Queen Elizabeth II** died on **8 September 2022**; **King Charles III** (crowned **6 May 2023**).

7.2 Starmer (2024–2026) and Burnham (2026–)

- **4 July 2024**: Labour **411** seats on about **34 per cent** of the vote; Conservatives **121**; Liberal Democrats **72**; **Reform UK** 5 seats but about 14 per cent of the vote.
- **Policies**: growth and planning reform; Great British Energy; public ownership of the railways (from 2025); workers' rights (the Employment Rights Bill); VAT on private-school fees (2025); a rise in employers' National Insurance (2025).
- **Foreign**: support for Ukraine and the "coalition of the willing"; defence spending to rise; the EU **reset** (2025); the **Chagos** agreement (2025); recognition of **Palestine** (September 2025).
- **Foreign policy, 2025**: the **Chagos agreement** with Mauritius (signed **22 May 2025**; Diego Garcia leased back for 99 years); the **UK–EU summit** (May 2025); the **UK–India trade agreement** (signed **24 July 2025**, in force **July 2026**); recognition of the **State of Palestine** (**21 September 2025**); defence spending to rise.
- **Troubles**: weak growth and tax rises; welfare U-turns (2025); the resignation of Deputy PM **Angela Rayner** over unpaid stamp duty (**5 September 2025**) and a major reshuffle — Lammy Deputy PM, Cooper Foreign Secretary, Mahmood Home Secretary; the rise of **Reform UK** in the polls and in the **May 2025** local elections.
- **The May 2026 elections** (7 May): Labour lost about **1,500 councillors** and control of **38** councils. In **Scotland** the **SNP** won **58** of 129 seats (short of a majority), with **Reform UK** and Labour on 17 each. In **Wales** — the first election to an enlarged, 96-member **Senedd** by proportional representation — **Plaid Cymru** won **43** seats and **Reform UK** **34**; Labour's century of dominance in Wales ended, and **Rhun ap Iorwerth** became First Minister of a Plaid minority government.
- **The fall of Starmer**: a Labour leadership crisis followed; **Andy Burnham**, Mayor of Greater Manchester, won the **Makerfield by-election** (**18 June 2026**, about 55 per cent); Starmer announced his resignation (**22 June 2026**).

- **Andy Burnham** was elected Labour leader **unopposed (17 July 2026)** and became **Prime Minister** on **20 July 2026** — the fourth Labour PM since 1997 and the seventh PM in ten years.

Chapter 8 · 1997–2012: Renewal or Unresolved Contradictions?

Area	Renewal	Unresolved contradictions
Constitution	Devolution; the Good Friday Agreement; the Human Rights Act; FOI; Lords reform (1999); the Supreme Court (2009)	The " English question " (West Lothian); the SNP won power (2007) and a majority (2011) → the 2014 referendum; the HRA v anti-terror laws; Lords reform unfinished (the 2012 bill abandoned); AV rejected (2011)
Foreign policy	"Ethical dimension"; Kosovo; Sierra Leone; aid and debt relief; climate leadership	Iraq (an illegal war?); rendition and torture; Libya (2011); pro-European words but no euro; Lisbon without a referendum
Economy	Bank independence; long growth; minimum wage; public services rebuilt	Light regulation → the 2008 crash ; debt; inequality; regional divides
Identity	" Cool Britannia "; a confident multicultural nation; civil partnerships; the London 2012 Olympics	The Britishness debate (Brown); 7/7 and home-grown terror; immigration after 2004; the rise of UKIP

Judgement: the period was a **genuine renewal** — Britain's constitution, public services, social attitudes and international profile were transformed — but it left **contradictions** (over sovereignty, Europe, the Union, liberty and security, and a debt-fuelled economy) that were papered over until **2012** and then broke open: the **Scottish referendum** (2014), the **Brexit** vote (2016) and a decade of turmoil.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Where Chapter 8 has been asked

2026 Q7 (1997–2012: renewal or unresolved contradictions?).

Part Four — Historians and Quotations

Writer	The view to quote
Anthony Giddens , <i>The Third Way</i> (1998)	The theory of New Labour.
Stuart Hall , "The Great Moving Nowhere Show" (1998)	New Labour as Thatcherism continued.
Anthony Seldon , <i>Blair</i> (2004) and later volumes	Blair's achievements and failures.
Andrew Rawnsley , <i>The End of the Party</i> (2010)	The Blair–Brown rivalry.
Sir John Chilcot , <i>The Iraq Inquiry</i> (2016)	The case against the Iraq decision.
Mark Blyth , <i>Austerity</i> (2013)	Austerity as "a dangerous idea".
Thiemo Fetzer (2019)	Austerity increased the Leave vote.
Vernon Bogdanor , <i>The New British Constitution</i> (2009)	The constitutional revolution after 1997.

"A new dawn has broken, has it not?" — **Blair**, 2 May 1997

"She was the People's Princess." — **Blair**, 31 August 1997

"We will find those who did it, we will smoke them out of their holes ..." — **George W. Bush**, September 2001

"I will be with you, whatever." — **Blair** to Bush, July 2002 (*Chilcot Report*)

"We're all in this together." — **George Osborne**, 2009–10

Part Five — The Examiner's Record

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2016 · Q7 · Section B	Discuss the main features of the foreign policy of David Cameron with special reference to the Middle East.	David Cameron	Policy analysis
2017 · Q8 · Section B	What are the advantages and disadvantages of Brexit for England? Analyse with arguments.	Brexit	Impact / significance
2018 · Q8(c) · Section B	<i>Short note:</i> Lady Diana	Diana, Princess of Wales	Short note
2021 · Q8 · Section B	What were the salient features of Tony Blair's policy on the War on Terror? How did his policy affect US-Britain relations?	The War on Terror	Policy analysis
2023 · Q7 · Section B	'We will find those who did it, we will smoke them out of their holes, we will get them running and we will bring them to justice.' In the context of this remark, present a balanced critique of the War on Terror with special emphasis on the role of Great Britain.	The War on Terror	Quotation / claim
2023 · Q8 · Section B	How did the global financial crisis plunge Britain into recession in the 21st century and how did it respond?	The 2008 financial crisis	Causes / results
2024 · Q7(b) · Section B	<i>Short note:</i> Reforms under David Cameron	David Cameron	Short note
2025 · Q6 · Section B	How did the policies of New Labour under Tony Blair differ from those of previous Labour governments? Was it a continuation of Thatcherism by other means, or did it represent a distinct political project?	Blair and New Labour	How far / extent
2025 · Q7 · Section B	How did the global financial crisis of 2008 impact British politics and society? How did the responses of the Labour and Conservative governments differ, and what were their long-term effects?	The 2008 financial crisis	Impact / significance
2025 · Q8(c) · Section B	<i>Short note:</i> Reforms under Cameron Government	David Cameron	Short note
2026 · Q7 · Section B	From 1997 to 2012, Britain saw dramatic shifts in foreign policy, constitutional reform and international identity. Assess whether the period should be interpreted as one of renewal or of unresolved contradictions in British governance.	Blair and New Labour	How far / extent
2026 · Q8(a) · Section B	<i>Short note:</i> Britain's role in the War on Terror	The War on Terror	Short note
2026 · Q8(b) · Section B	<i>Short note:</i> Lady Diana Spencer	Diana, Princess of Wales	Short note

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · The pattern

The War on Terror (2021: Blair's policy and US relations; 2023: a critique with Bush's words; 2026 short note). **New Labour** (2025: v Old Labour and Thatcherism; 2026: renewal or contradictions 1997–2012). **The financial crisis** (2023: recession and response; 2025: impact, the two responses, long-term effects). **Cameron** (2016: foreign policy in the Middle East; short notes on his reforms 2024, 2025). **Brexit** (2017). **Diana** (short notes 2018, 2026). Not yet set: **devolution** and the **Good Friday Agreement** as full questions, **May and Johnson**, **Covid**, **Starmer**.

Part Six — The One-Liner Bank

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use the one-liners

Cover the answer after the arrow and say it aloud. **120 questions**; bold words are the ones examiners test. The past MCQs are solved in T10QA.

One-liners · New Labour

1. Which party governed under **Tony Blair**? → The **Labour** Party.
2. When did Blair win his first election? → **1 May 1997**.
3. How many seats did Labour win in 1997? → **418**.
4. When did Blair rewrite **Clause IV**? → **1995**.
5. Who wrote *The Third Way* (1998)? → **Anthony Giddens**.
6. What did Blair say were his three priorities? → "**Education, education, education**".
7. What did Brown give the Bank of England in **May 1997**? → **Independence** to set interest rates.
8. When did the **minimum wage** begin? → **April 1999** (£3.60 an hour).
9. What was **Sure Start** (1998)? → **Children's centres** for families in poor areas.
10. What did Labour pledge on **child poverty** (1999)? → To **halve** it by 2010 and **end** it by 2020.
11. When were tuition fees first introduced? → **1998** (£1,000).
12. What new type of school did Labour create in **2000**? → **Academies**.
13. When did the **Scottish Parliament** and **Welsh Assembly** open? → **1999**.
14. When was the **Good Friday Agreement** signed? → **10 April 1998**.
15. Which conflict did it address? → **Northern Ireland**.
16. Which US senator chaired the talks? → **George Mitchell**.
17. Which Act (1998) brought the ECHR into UK law? → The **Human Rights Act**.
18. How many hereditary peers stayed after **1999**? → **92**.
19. Which Act (2000) gave a right to official information? → The **Freedom of Information Act**.
20. When did the **Supreme Court** open? → **2009**.
21. When were **civil partnerships** introduced? → **2004**.
22. Who promised an "**ethical dimension**" to foreign policy? → **Robin Cook** (1997).
23. What did Blair's **Chicago speech** (1999) set out? → The "**doctrine of the international community**".

- 24.** Which **2000** intervention saved Sierra Leone's capital? → **Operation Palliser.**
- 25.** Which **2005** summit focused on Africa and climate? → **Gleneagles G8.**
- 26.** Who called New Labour her "greatest achievement"? → **Margaret Thatcher.**
- 27.** Who called New Labour "the great moving nowhere show"? → **Stuart Hall.**
- 28.** When did **Gordon Brown** become PM? → **June 2007.**
- 29.** Which **2008** Act set legal carbon targets? → The **Climate Change Act.**
- 30.** What scandal broke in **May 2009**? → The **MPs' expenses** scandal.

One-liners · The War on Terror

- 31.** When were the **9/11** attacks? → **11 September 2001.**
- 32.** Which group carried them out? → **Al-Qaeda.**
- 33.** What did Blair promise the USA? → To stand "**shoulder to shoulder**".
- 34.** Who said "we will smoke them out of their holes"? → **George W. Bush** (September 2001).
- 35.** When did the war in **Afghanistan** begin? → **October 2001.**
- 36.** Which government sheltered bin Laden? → The **Taliban.**
- 37.** Which Afghan province did British forces take over in 2006? → **Helmand.**
- 38.** How many British servicemen died in Afghanistan? → **457.**
- 39.** When did British combat operations in Afghanistan end? → **2014.**
- 40.** When did the Taliban retake Kabul? → **August 2021.**
- 41.** When was bin Laden killed? → **May 2011.**
- 42.** Which PM sent British troops to **Iraq** in 2003? → **Tony Blair.**
- 43.** What was Iraq said to possess? → **Weapons of mass destruction.**
- 44.** What claim in the September 2002 dossier became notorious? → WMD ready "within **45 minutes**".
- 45.** Which UN resolution (Nov 2002) gave Iraq a "final opportunity"? → **Resolution 1441.**
- 46.** How many marched against the war in London (Feb 2003)? → About **1 million.**
- 47.** Which minister resigned over Iraq? → **Robin Cook.**
- 48.** When did the invasion begin? → **20 March 2003.**
- 49.** Which Iraqi city did British forces hold? → **Basra.**
- 50.** How many British servicemen died in Iraq? → **179.**
- 51.** Which weapons expert died in July 2003? → **Dr David Kelly.**
- 52.** Which report (2016) judged the Iraq decision? → The **Chilcot Report.**
- 53.** When were the **7/7** London bombings? → **7 July 2005.**
- 54.** How many people did they kill? → **52.**

- 55. Which strategy aims to stop radicalisation? → **Prevent**.
- 56. What was Blair's first Commons defeat (2005)? → **90-day** detention without charge.
- 57. What nickname did critics give Blair? → "**Bush's poodle**".
- 58. Which terrorist group arose from the chaos in Iraq and Syria? → **ISIS** (Islamic State).

One-liners · The financial crisis

- 59. What is the 2008 downturn called? → The (global) **Financial Crisis**.
- 60. Which bank suffered Britain's first run in 150 years (2007)? → **Northern Rock**.
- 61. Which US bank collapsed in September 2008? → **Lehman Brothers**.
- 62. When was the great bank rescue? → **8 October 2008**.
- 63. Which banks did the state part-own? → **RBS** and **Lloyds**.
- 64. To what level was Bank Rate cut in March 2009? → **0.5 per cent**.
- 65. What is **quantitative easing**? → The Bank of England **creating money** to buy bonds.
- 66. To what was VAT cut in December 2008? → **15 per cent**.
- 67. Where was the **G20** summit of April 2009? → **London**.
- 68. By how much did GDP fall in the recession? → About **6 per cent**.
- 69. Who was Labour's Chancellor during the crisis? → **Alistair Darling**.
- 70. Who was the coalition's Chancellor? → **George Osborne**.
- 71. What was the coalition's economic policy called? → **Austerity**.
- 72. To what did the coalition raise VAT (2011)? → **20 per cent**.
- 73. Which report recommended bank **ring-fencing**? → The **Vickers** report (2011).
- 74. Which two bodies replaced the FSA (2013)? → The **PRA** and the **FCA**.
- 75. What did Osborne say about austerity? → "**We're all in this together**."
- 76. What charity's food-bank use soared after 2008? → The **Trussell Trust**.

One-liners · Cameron

- 77. What type of government did Cameron form in 2010? → A **coalition** government.
- 78. With which party? → The **Liberal Democrats**.
- 79. Who led the 2010–15 coalition? → **David Cameron** (Clegg was deputy).
- 80. What was Nick Clegg's post? → **Deputy Prime Minister**.
- 81. Which benefit merged six others? → **Universal Credit**.
- 82. Which Act (2012) created it? → The **Welfare Reform Act**.
- 83. To what did tuition fees rise in 2012? → **£9,000**.
- 84. What extra money did poorer pupils get from 2011? → The **pupil premium**.

- 85.** Which Act (2013) allowed same-sex marriage? → The **Marriage (Same Sex Couples) Act**.
- 86.** Which Act of 2015 targeted modern slavery? → The **Modern Slavery Act**.
- 87.** What aid target was written into law (2015)? → **0.7 per cent** of national income.
- 88.** What was introduced in April 2016 for over-25s? → The **National Living Wage**.
- 89.** Which Act (2011) fixed five-year parliaments? → The **Fixed-term Parliaments Act**.
- 90.** What was the result of the **AV referendum** (2011)? → **No** (about 68 per cent).
- 91.** What was the Scottish referendum result (2014)? → **55.3 per cent No**.
- 92.** Which UN resolution (2011) authorised action in **Libya**? → **Resolution 1973**.
- 93.** When did the Commons reject strikes on **Syria**? → **29 August 2013**.
- 94.** When did Britain begin air strikes on ISIS in Syria? → **December 2015**.
- 95.** Which deal with Iran (2015) did Cameron support? → The **nuclear deal** (JCPOA).
- 96.** What did Cameron call relations with China? → A "**golden era**".
- 97.** What was Cameron's vision of community action? → The "**Big Society**".

One-liners · Brexit and after

- 98.** When was the EU referendum? → **23 June 2016**.
- 99.** What percentage voted Leave? → **51.9 per cent**.
- 100.** What was the Leave slogan? → "**Take Back Control**".
- 101.** Which nations voted Remain? → **Scotland and Northern Ireland**.
- 102.** Who succeeded Cameron? → **Theresa May**.
- 103.** When was **Article 50** triggered? → **29 March 2017**.
- 104.** By how much was May's deal first defeated? → **230** votes.
- 105.** What was Johnson's slogan in 2019? → "**Get Brexit Done**".
- 106.** When did Britain leave the EU? → **31 January 2020**.
- 107.** Which agreement (2023) eased the Northern Ireland Protocol? → The **Windsor Framework**.
- 108.** Which Pacific trade bloc did Britain join? → The **CPTPP**.
- 109.** Who was the shortest-serving PM (49 days)? → **Liz Truss** (2022).
- 110.** Who was the first British Asian PM? → **Rishi Sunak**.
- 111.** When did Elizabeth II die? → **8 September 2022**.
- 112.** How many seats did Labour win in **2024**? → **411**.
- 113.** Who succeeded Starmer as Prime Minister in **July 2026**? → **Andy Burnham**.

One-liners · Diana

- 114.** When was **Diana Spencer** born? → **1 July 1961.**
- 115.** When did she marry Prince Charles? → **29 July 1981.**
- 116.** Which weapons did she campaign against in 1997? → **Landmines.**
- 117.** Which disease's stigma did she challenge (1987)? → **HIV/AIDS.**
- 118.** What did she say in her 1995 Panorama interview? → **"There were three of us in this marriage."**
- 119.** When and where did she die? → **31 August 1997, Paris.**
- 120.** What did Blair call her? → **"The People's Princess".**

Part Seven — Revision Sheet · Topic 10: Blair to Burnham

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own for the night before the paper. Asked: War on Terror (2021, 2023, 2026 sn), New Labour (2025, 2026), financial crisis (2023, 2025), Cameron (2016; reforms sn 2024, 2025), Brexit (2017), Diana (sn 2018, 2026).

R10.1 New Labour

Making: four defeats; Kinnock, Smith; **Blair leader 1994; Clause IV 1995; Third Way** (Giddens). **Elections:** 1997 (**418**), 2001 (413), 2005 (355). **Economy: Bank of England independence 1997;** prudence; low income tax; windfall tax, New Deal; long boom; light regulation; PFI. **Social: minimum wage 1999;** tax credits; child-poverty pledge; **Sure Start 1998;** NHS spending doubled; academies 2000; tuition fees 1998/2004; civil partnerships 2004; Equality Act 2010. **Constitution: devolution 1999; Good Friday Agreement 10 April 1998; HRA 1998;** Lords Act 1999 (92); FOI 2000; London Mayor 2000; Supreme Court 2009. **Foreign:** ethical dimension (Cook); **Kosovo 1999,** Chicago speech; **Sierra Leone 2000;** DfID; Gleneagles 2005; Social Chapter; St Malo; no euro. **Brown 2007–10:** crisis; Climate Change Act 2008; expenses 2009. **v Old Labour:** no nationalisation; unions at arm's length; low tax; business. **v Thatcherism:** kept markets, union laws, low income tax — but minimum wage, tax credits, investment, constitution. **Verdict:** a distinct project on Thatcherite foundations (Hall: "moving nowhere"; Thatcher: "greatest achievement").

R10.2 The War on Terror

9/11 (11 Sept 2001; ~3,000 dead); Bush: "**smoke them out**"; Blair "**shoulder to shoulder**". **Afghanistan:** Oct 2001; Helmand 2006; **457** British dead; combat ended 2014; Taliban back Aug 2021; bin Laden killed 2011. **Iraq:** WMD; dossiers (**45 minutes**; "dodgy"); **Res. 1441;** 1m march (15 Feb 2003); Commons **412–149**, 139 Labour rebels; **Cook resigns;** invasion **20 March 2003;** ~46,000 troops; **no WMD;** Basra to 2009; **179** dead; Kelly; Hutton, Butler; **Chilcot 2016** ("I will be with you, whatever"). **Home:** Terrorism Act 2000; ATCSA 2001 (Belmarsh; Lords 2004); control orders 2005; **90 days defeated 2005; 7/7 2005 (52 dead);** Prevent. **US relations:** closest since 1945; influence (UN route, road map); "poodle"; Europe split; later Iraq syndrome (Syria 2013). **Critique:** al-Qaeda weakened, plots foiled v Iraq false case, huge deaths, ISIS, Taliban return, torture and rendition, more terror at home.

R10.3 The financial crisis

Causes: US sub-prime; securitisation; UK banks' huge balance sheets; light regulation. **UK: Northern Rock run Sept 2007** (nationalised Feb 2008); **Lehman 15 Sept 2008;** Lloyds—

HBOS; **rescue 8 Oct 2008** (~£500bn; RBS, Lloyds); rates **0.5%** (Mar 2009); **QE** (£375bn by 2012); VAT 15%; **G20 London Apr 2009**. **Recession**: GDP -6%; unemployment ~2.5–2.7m; borrowing ~10% GDP. **Labour** (Brown, Darling): Keynesian stimulus, rescue, 50p tax. **Coalition** (Cameron, **Osborne**): **austerity**, VAT 20%, cuts, welfare reform, Universal Credit; bank reform (Vickers ring-fencing; PRA/FCA 2013). **Impact**: Labour defeat 2010; coalition; distrust; protests; riots 2011; UKIP; wage stagnation; food banks; inequality. **Long-term**: productivity puzzle; QE and asset prices; strained services; high debt; safer banks; Brexit and populism.

R10.4 Cameron

Coalition with **Liberal Democrats** (Clegg) 11 May 2010; majority 2015. **Reforms**: austerity; **Universal Credit** (2012), benefit cap; allowance to £11,000; triple lock; auto-enrolment; **National Living Wage 2016**; **academies and free schools**; Gove curriculum; **pupil premium**; fees £9,000; **Health and Social Care Act 2012**; **same-sex marriage 2013**; **Modern Slavery Act 2015**; **0.7% aid law**; Big Society; Leveson; **Fixed-term Parliaments 2011**; **AV referendum 2011 (No)**; **Scottish referendum 2014 (55.3% No)**; **EVEL**; **EU referendum 2016**. **Foreign**: liberal conservatism; China "golden era"; Russia sanctions; **Middle East — Libya 2011** (Res. 1973; Gaddafi; chaos); **Syria** (vote lost 29 Aug 2013; refugees; strikes Dec 2015); **ISIS** strikes 2014–15; **Iran deal 2015**; Saudi arms; Bahrain base; Palestine vote 2014; Afghanistan ended 2014.

R10.5 Brexit

Referendum **23 June 2016: 51.9% Leave**; Scotland, NI Remain; "Take Back Control". May: Article 50 (29 Mar 2017); 2017 election; deal defeated by 230. Johnson: majority 80 (Dec 2019); **left 31 Jan 2020**; TCA; **Windsor Framework 2023**. **Advantages**: sovereignty, no EU contributions, own trade deals (Australia, NZ, CPTPP, India), regulatory freedom (vaccine), end of free movement. **Disadvantages**: trade barriers (OBR: trade -15%, productivity -4%), investment, labour shortages, record net migration anyway, NI and Scotland, lost influence, Erasmus. Opinion turned; **2025 reset**.

R10.6 Diana

Born **1 July 1961**; married Charles **29 July 1981** (750m viewers); William 1982, Harry 1984; **AIDS** (1987), leprosy, homeless, **landmines** (Angola Jan 1997; Ottawa Treaty Dec 1997); separation 1992; **Panorama 1995** ("three of us"); divorce 1996; died **31 Aug 1997**, Paris; "**People's Princess**" (Blair); grief; the Queen criticised; funeral 6 Sept; inquest 2008 (unlawful killing — driver and paparazzi); Dyson 2021.

R10.7 Since 2016 and the big question

May (Grenfell); Johnson (Covid, vaccines, partygate, Ukraine); **Truss 49 days**; **Sunak** first British Asian PM; **Elizabeth II d. 8 Sept 2022**; **Starmer 4 July 2024 (411)**; Chagos, India deal, EU reset, Palestine recognised (2025); Rayner resigns (Sept 2025); **May 2026**: Labour

routed, **Plaid** governs Wales, SNP largest in Scotland, **Reform** surges; **Burnham** wins Makerfield (June), **PM 20 July 2026. 1997–2012: renewal or contradictions?** Renewal: constitution, peace, rights, services, aid, Cool Britannia, London 2012. Contradictions: English question and SNP; HRA v terror laws; Iraq; Europe without the euro; debt-fuelled boom → crash; Britishness, 7/7, immigration. **Verdict:** real renewal whose contradictions exploded after 2012 (Scotland 2014, Brexit 2016).

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

New Labour renewed Britain's public services and constitution but tied it to America's wars and a fragile financial boom; the crash brought austerity, the austerity years brought Brexit, and Brexit brought a decade of turmoil that ended with Labour back in power in 2024.